

2.1 The Origins Of The iPod

Until 2001, the portable music player market was in its infancy. Small-capacity players, clunky and primitive interfaces, poor battery life. Then in October 2001, Apple introduced the iPod. This player boasted of 1000 CD-quality songs packed into an ultra-portable device that fit comfortably inside a pocket. The first iPod had a 5 GB hard drive, 10 hours of music playback, and a 160 x 128 pixel display. But it



The 1st Generation iPod—notice the lack of the clickwheel

was not these features that set the iPod apart from other players. It was that the iPod introduced the click-wheel, a scroll-wheel to thumb through the music collection. The iPod also came with the FireWire interface, which was much faster than the USB 1.1 speeds available to most other music players.

The iPod caught on mainly because it was easy to use, which was facilitated by its easy syncing capabilities with iTunes. Just plug the iPod in, and the library was automatically synced via FireWire. The first generation iPod was a Mac only device.

2.1.1 Second, Third, Fourth, Fifth

The second-generation iPod was more of an upgrade to the first generation. Introduced in March 2002, it offered 10 GB of disk space and also offered storing of contacts information inside the iPod. The iPod was still a Mac only device.

Then Apple introduced iTunes for Windows—a giant leap for Apple as it expanded its customer base. This release also meant the release of the third-generation iPod, in September 2003, with a giant leap in hard drive capacity with 20 GB / 40 GB models. The new iPod also had a facelift, was thinner, smaller and the control